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Families Migrating West · Nov 28, 2011 · Public

The Great Trail from Fort Pitt to Detroit

RED-MEN'S ROADS: The Indian Thoroughfares of the Central West

By Archer Butler Hulbert <http://goo.gl/QYH1o>

Following is the author's description of the Mahoning Trail route.

THE MAHONING TRAIL

The trails went from Fort Pitt to Fort Sandusky. From Ft. Pitt it followed the “Great Trail” to near the mouth of the Beaver River and then ascended the Beaver and Mahoning Valleys. It then crossed the **Portage Path** between the Cuyahoga and Tuscarawas River and followed the watershed until the “Great Trail” was met at the Sandusky River and then descended the river to Fort Sandusky.

A second class trail used largely by runners between Ft. Detroit and the Pennsylvania frontier, to avoid passing over the “Great Trail.”

PORTAGE PATH

It is probably one of the oldest highways in the west, having been the route of the buffaloes across the summit of the State. In later years it became the portage for the Indians from the lake country to the streams flowing south. The length of the path was eight miles. The current Portage Trail road follows the old trail.

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Mahoning Trail = Blue line

Great Trail = Black line



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